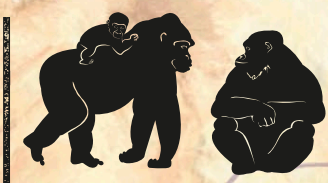


BETWEEN 1995 AND 2000, THE **EBOLA VIRUS KILLED THREE-QUARTERS OF THE WESTERN GORILLA POPULATION**

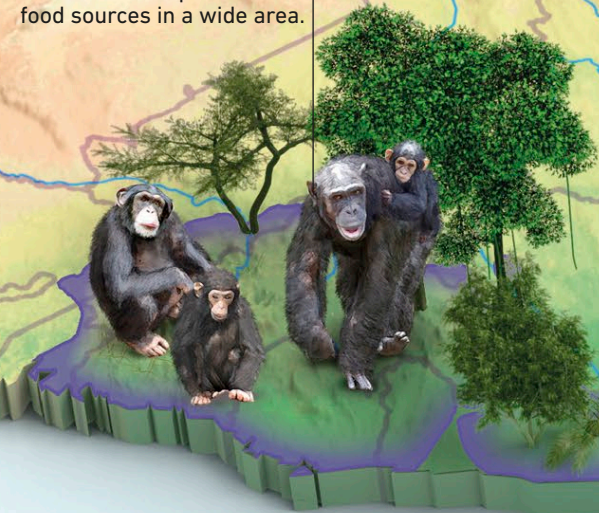


GREAT APES LIVE IN **LARGE FAMILY GROUPS**—ONE EASTERN GORILLA GROUP HAD A RECORD **65 MEMBERS**

ANIMALS IN DANGER	
Chimpanzee	
⚠ IUCN status: endangered	
📈 Population estimate: 340,000–430,000	
Bonobo	
⚠ IUCN status: endangered	
📈 Population estimate: unknown	
Western gorilla	
⚠ IUCN status: critically endangered	
📈 Population estimate: 316,000	
Eastern gorilla	
⚠ IUCN status: critically endangered	
📈 Population estimate: fewer than 5,000	

KEY	
🟡	Chimpanzee
🟢	Bonobo
🟠	Western gorilla
🔴	Eastern gorilla

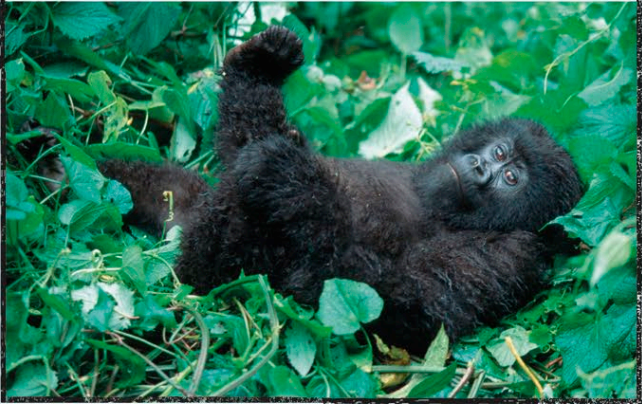
Finding food
In West Africa's rainforests, families of chimpanzees may travel long distances between fruiting trees. They build up a mental map of the best food sources in a wide area.



Western gorilla
The western gorilla lives in lowland and hill forests. Males in these areas often develop a chestnut crown of hair on their head. Some populations make their home in swamplands that get flooded during the rainy season.



Green living
Great apes use branches and foliage to build nests for sleeping at night, and sometimes for resting during the day. Chimpanzee and bonobo nests are built high in trees but gorillas, who are heavier, often nest on the ground, like the one seen here.



Great apes

The great apes are our closest animal relatives. All great ape species, except the orangutans (see pp.126–127), are found on the continent of Africa. Living in sociable groups in forests around the equator, chimpanzees and bonobos spend more time in trees, while gorillas stay mainly on the ground.